

Guest Data and Interpretives Study Results

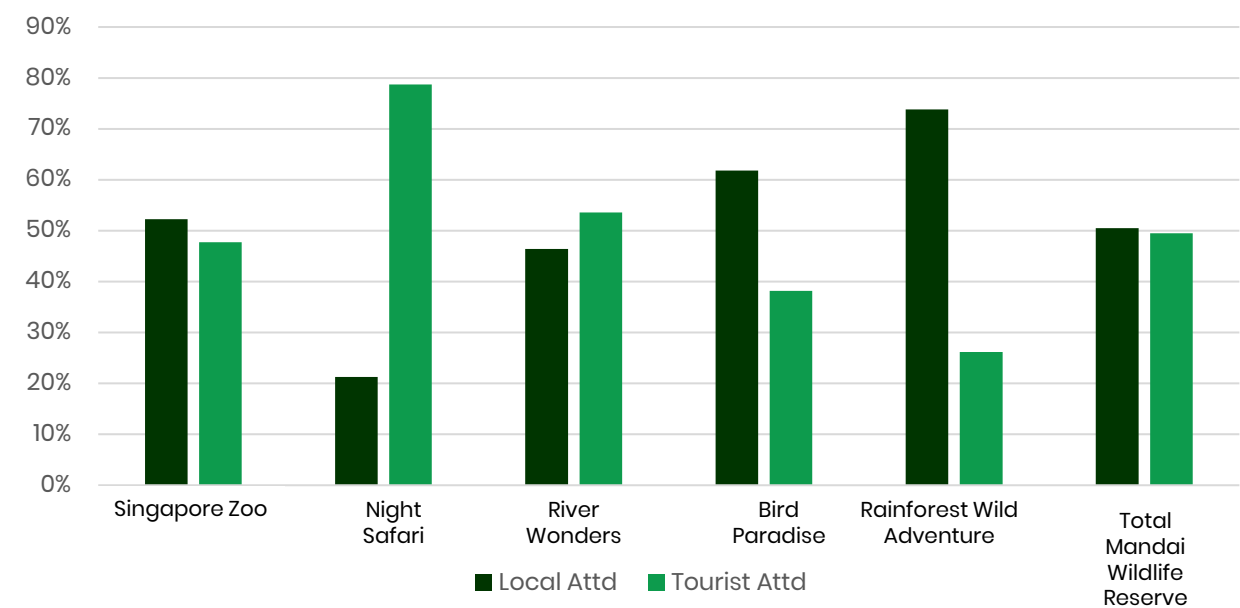
Hackathon for Students @ Amazon Web Services

31 July 2026

Demographic of Park Guests in Mandai

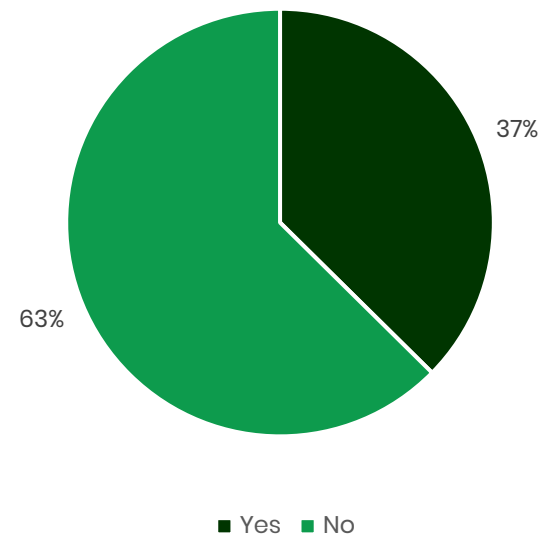
Equal proportions of locals vs tourists across all wildlife parks, but each wildlife park has its own unique mix.

Proportion of Locals and Tourists in Mandai



Almost 40% of guests are members (Friends of Mandai).

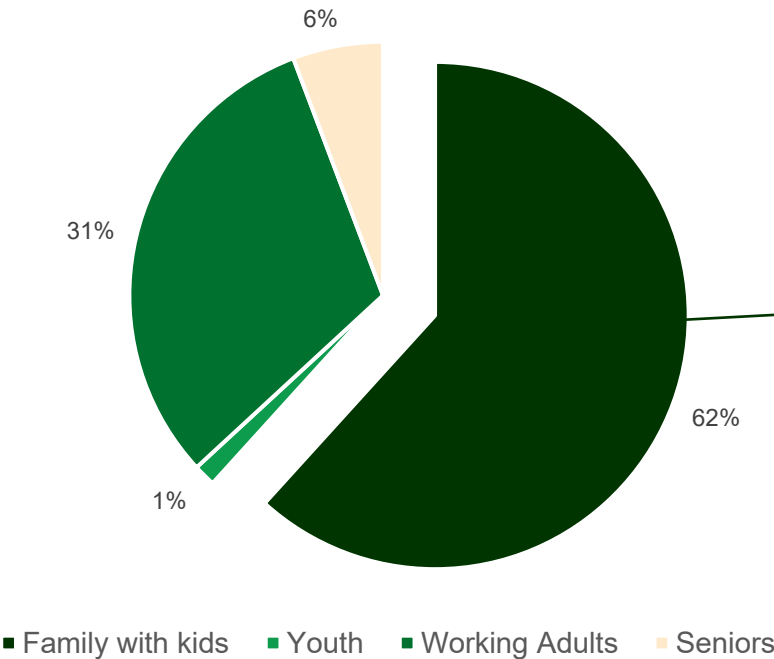
% of Guests who are Members



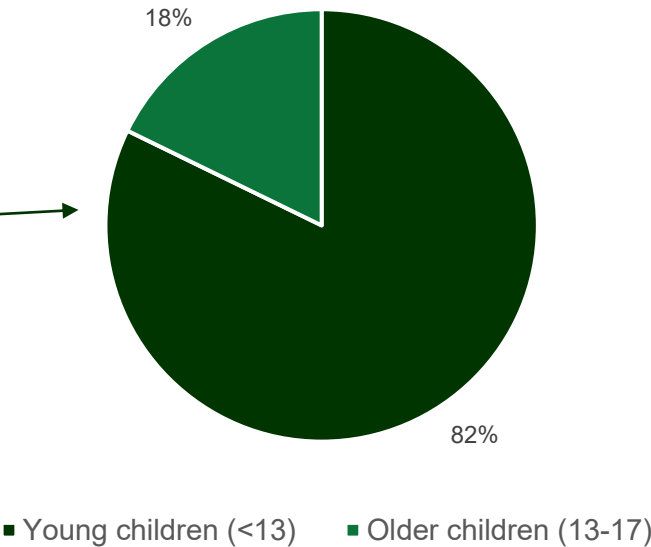
Demographic of Park Guests in Mandai

Guest Segments in Mandai (FY25/26):

Attendance by segment (% of total attendance)



Breakdown: Families with kids



How guests learned about conservation and sustainability in our parks

Percentage of times that guests mentioned they used each learning channel

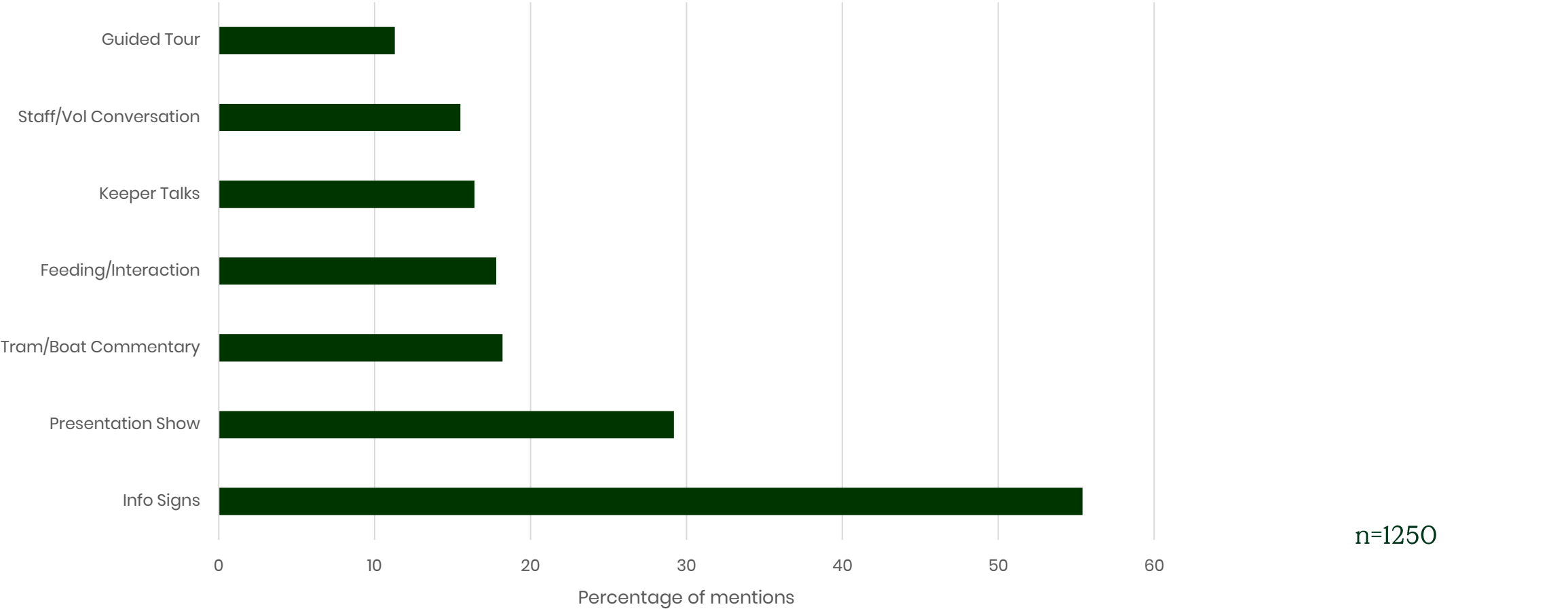


Exhibit Interpretive Study in Singapore Zoo

Interpretive use by Singapore Zoo park guests & interpretive characteristics that affect engagement.

Exhibits in Study

Interpretives:

- Collective term for physical artefacts and information signage on display.
- Typically found alongside animal and plant exhibits
- Provide information on flora and fauna, the environment, Mandai animal personalities, unique stories, and conservation messages.

These 3 exhibits were chosen for this study because of variety of interpretive types and presence of conservation messaging.



Sumatran Orangutan Hut



Armoured Reptiles



Tiger

Answering our questions through research

Question 1:

What proportion of guests interact with our interpretives?



Count total guests & number of guests who stop -> proportion

Question 2:

What interpretive characteristics cause guests to

- stop (Attraction)
- interact for longer (Holding time)?

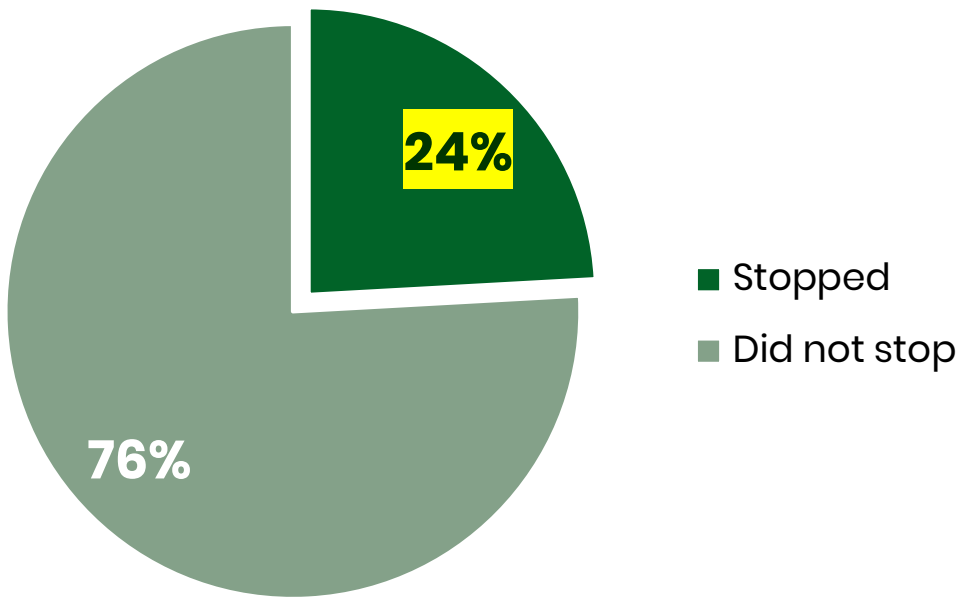


1. **Observe** which interpretives attract guests to stop at first
2. **Time** how long guests interact with each interpretive
3. **Interview** guests and **record verbatims** about what made guests stop and/or stay at an interpretive.

Q1:

**What proportion of guests interact with our
interpreters?**

Proportion of guests who stopped* at interpretives (n = 5471)



*Guests were deemed to have stopped if they were at least 3m from interpretive and had looked at it for at least 2s.

A quarter of our park guests use interpretives.

• Breakdown:

Orangutan Exhibit	%
Stopped	27%
Did not stop	73%
Total	

Tiger Exhibit	%
Stopped	18%
Did not stop	82%
Total	

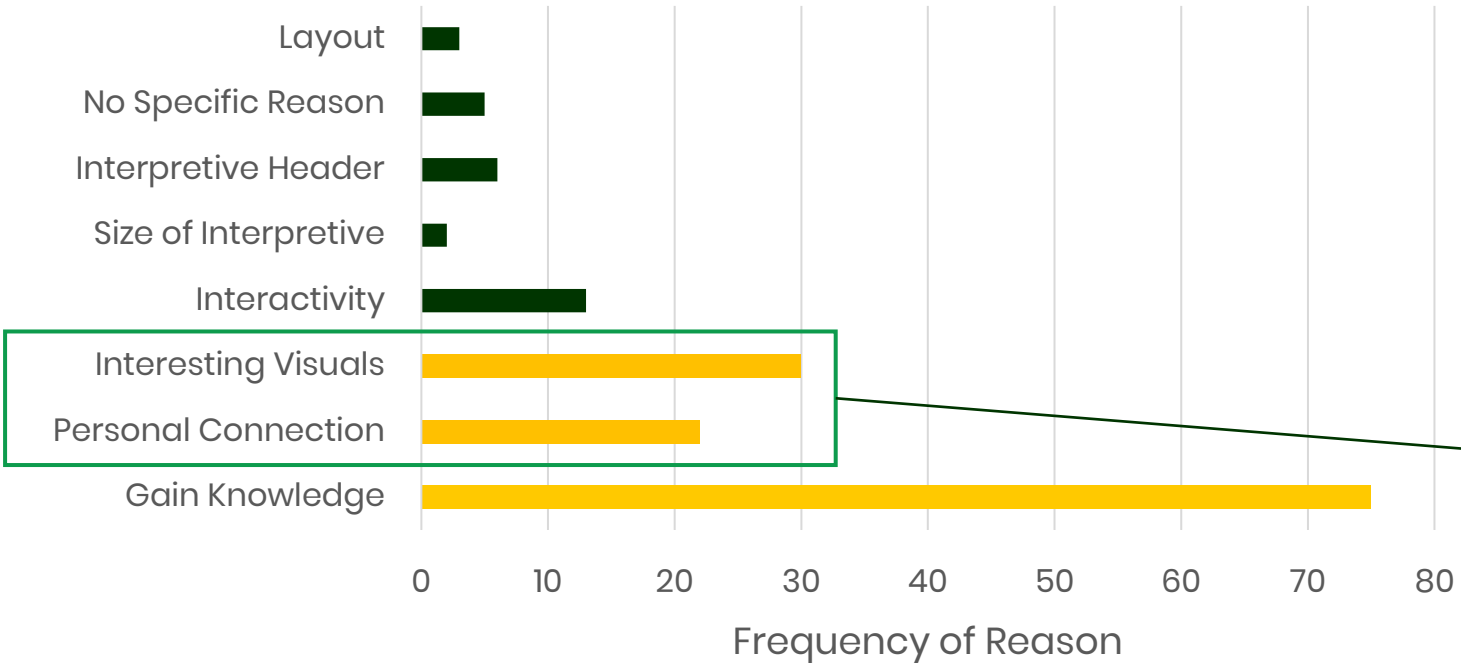
Armoured Reptile Exhibit	%
Stopped	25%
Did not stop	75%
Total	

Q2a:

**What interpretive characteristics cause
guests to stop at an interpretive?
(Attraction)**

Attraction: Characteristics of Attractive Interpretives

Reasons why guests are first attracted to interpretives



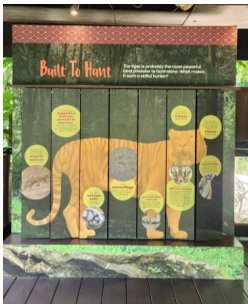
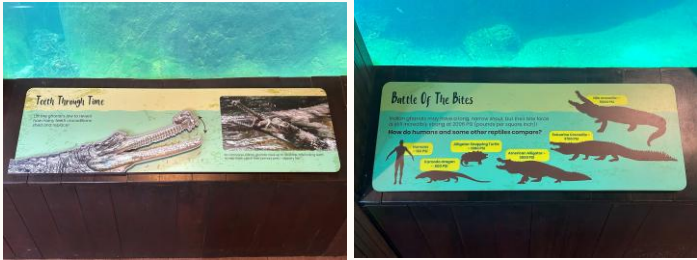
The top three factors that attract guests to **stop** at an interpretive are:

- 1. To find out more about the animal (gain knowledge)
- 2. Interesting visuals
- 3. Stories that have personal connections.

Factors we can change to encourage guests to notice and stop at an interpretive.

Attraction: Interpretives that were visited first

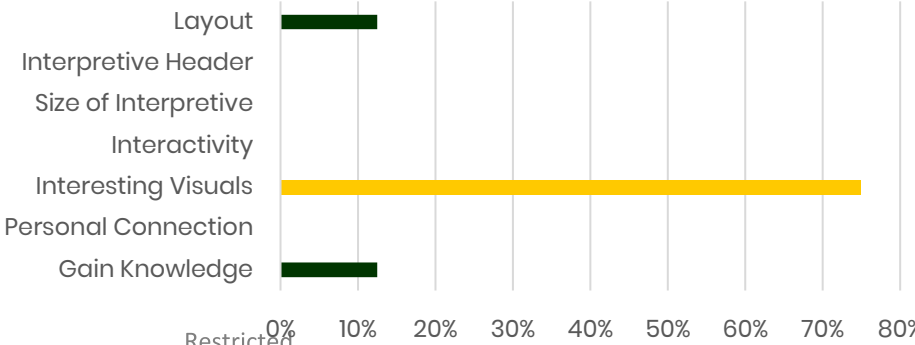
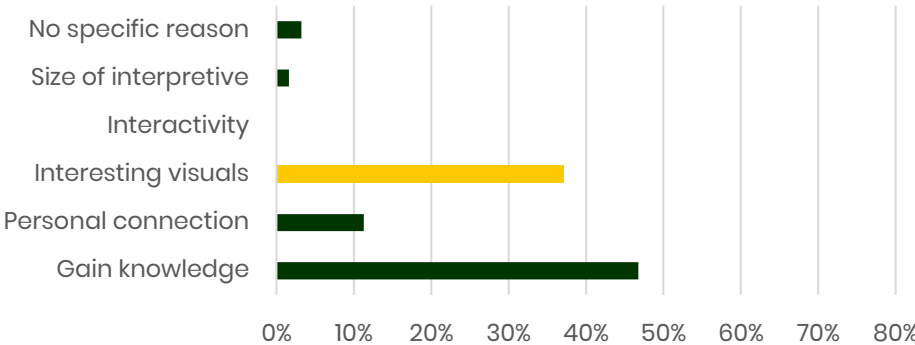
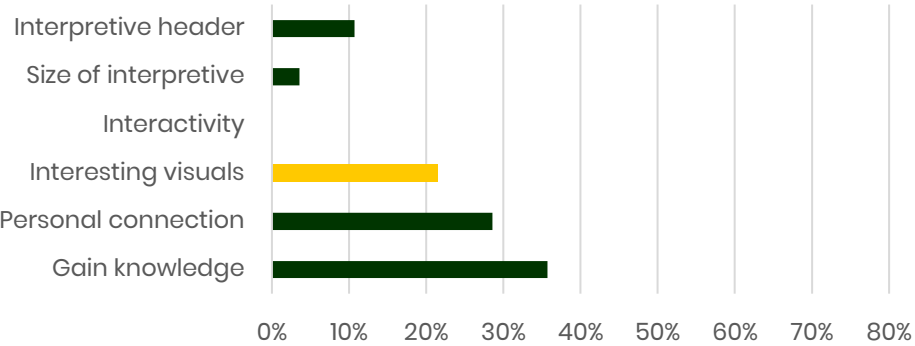
Results

Exhibit	Top 3 interpretives per exhibit that were visited first (Proportion of instances that they were visited first)		
Orangutan (n=52)	 OUI (46%) Static panel about an orangutan, Charlie's story	 OU2 (17%) Interactive puzzle feeder with static panel about enrichment	 OU5 (17%) Display case of daily products that contain palm oil with static panels about choosing CSPO
Tiger (n=84)	 T9 (81%) Static panel about tigers around the world and their conservation statuses	 T8 (11%) Interactive lenticular panels with info about tiger adaptations. Spinning the panels reveals a whole tiger skeleton.	 T7 (4%) Interactive audio buttons about tiger auditory communication + static panel about tiger body language.
Armoured Reptiles (n=43)	 AR16 (26%) Display case with gharial nest with eggs and hatchlings. Static panels about gharial parental care.	 AR3 (19%) Interactive lift-the-flap panel about the differences between gharials, alligators and crocodiles.	 AR2 & AR4 (12%) AR2: Interactive panel with movable gharial jaw – about feeding adaptations. AR4: Static panel comparing bite forces of different crocodilians and humans.

Strictly not for circulation.

Attraction: Profiles of Very Attractive Interpretives

Exhibit	Most attractive interpretive (Proportion of times they were visited first)	
Orangutan (n=52)		(46%)
Tiger (n=84)		T9 (81%)
Armoured Reptiles (n=43)		(26%)



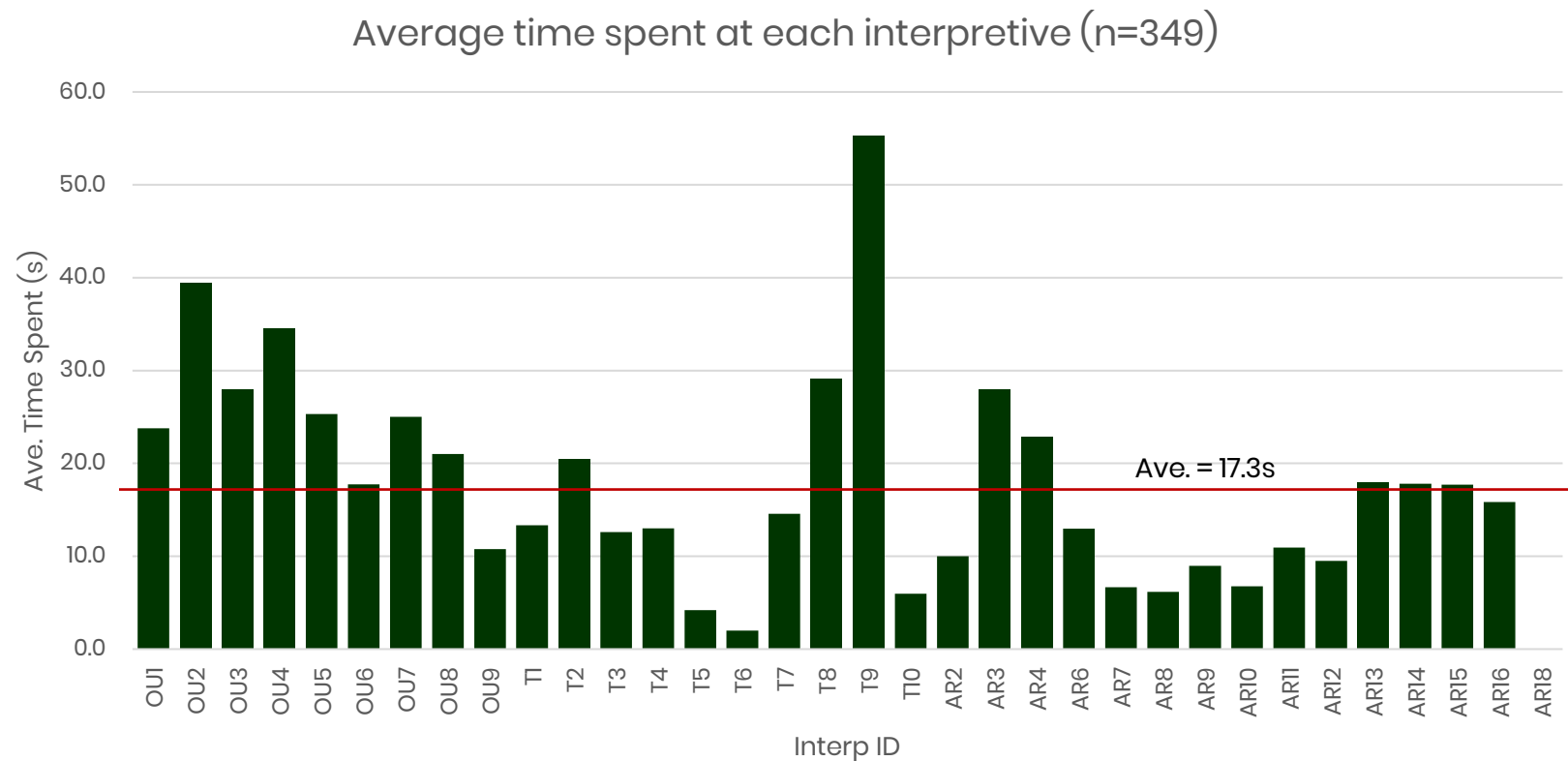
Having interesting visuals was a common factor among the most attractive interpretives in each exhibit.

Q2b:

**What interpretive characteristics cause
guests to interact for longer?**

(Holding time)

Holding Time: Interpretives that were interacted with for the longest time



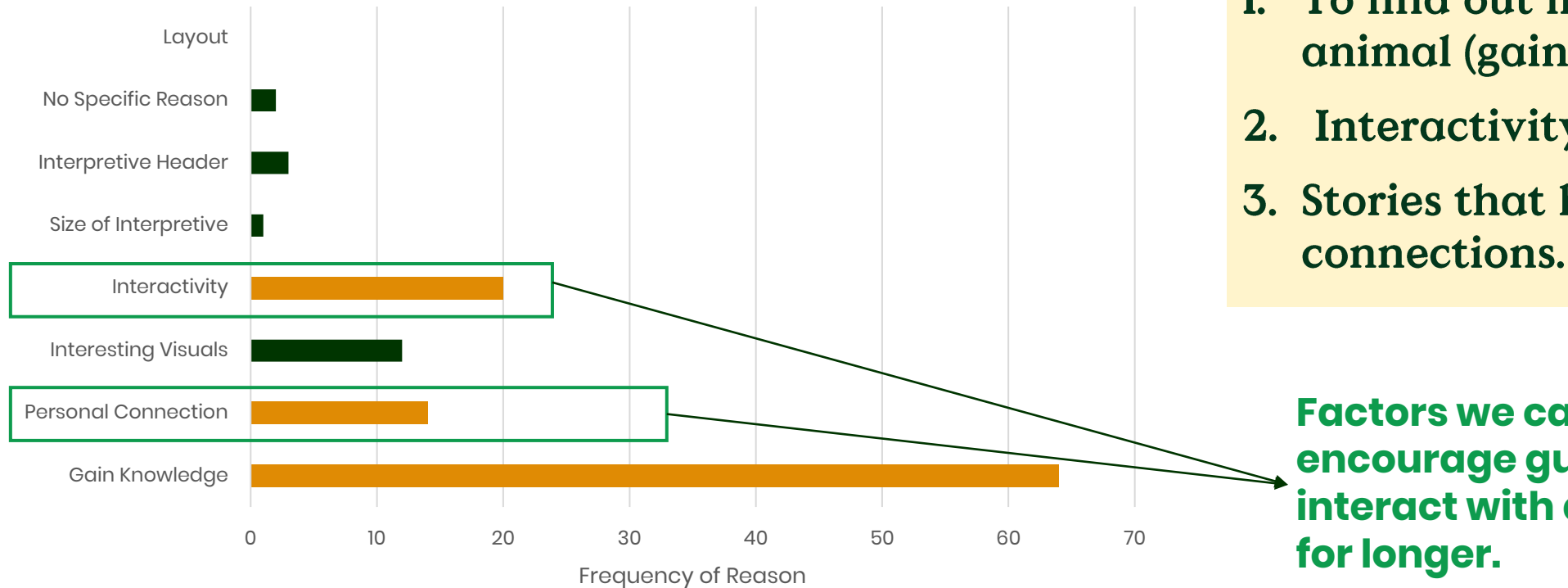
Time spent interacting* with one interpretive:

- Mean (average): **17.3s**
- Median: **15.2s**
- Range: **0.0s – 55.3s**

*Guest is deemed to be interacting with the interpretive if they are standing within 3m of it and looking at/manipulating it for at least 2 s.

Holding time: Interpretives that were interacted with for the longest time

Reasons for continuing to interact with interpretive



The top three factors that attract guests to **continue interacting** with an interpretive are:

1. To find out more about the animal (gain knowledge)
2. Interactivity
3. Stories that have personal connections.

Factors we can change to encourage guests to interact with an interpretive for longer.

Conclusions

1

Interpretives are an important part of our guests' experience.

- Guests want to learn about the animals they see
- 1/4 of guests use interps

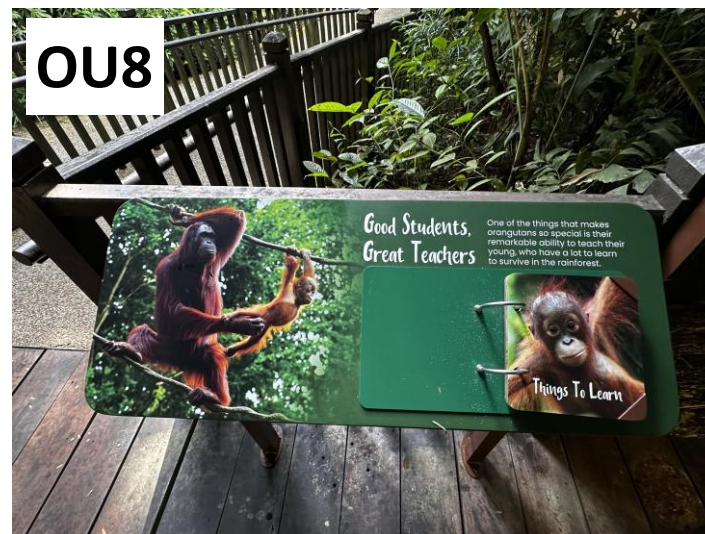
2

Top interpretive design recommendations:

1. Interesting visuals grab attention
2. Interactivity holds attention
3. Content with human-interest
4. Specific and feasible CTA

Annex

Interpretives at Orangutan Exhibit



Interpretives at Tiger Exhibit



Interpretives at Armoured Reptiles Exhibit

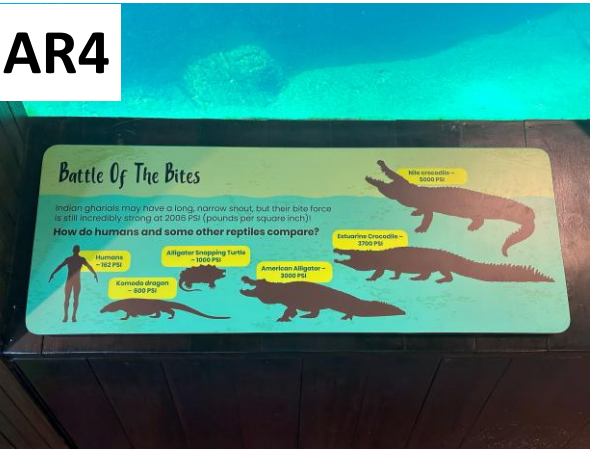
AR2



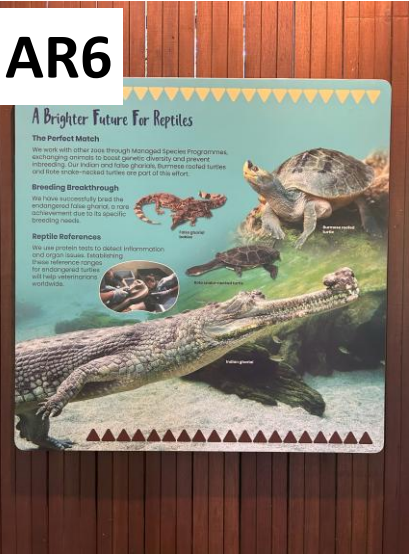
AR3



AR4



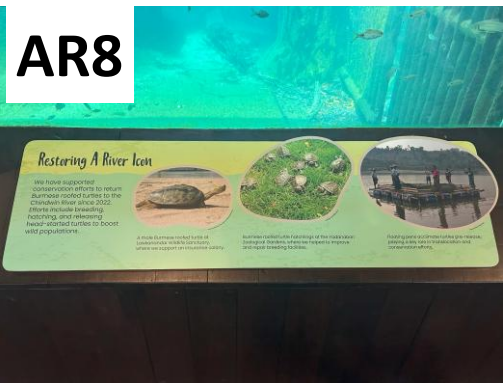
AR6



AR7



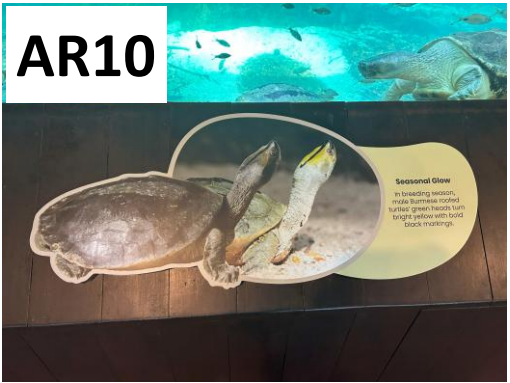
AR8



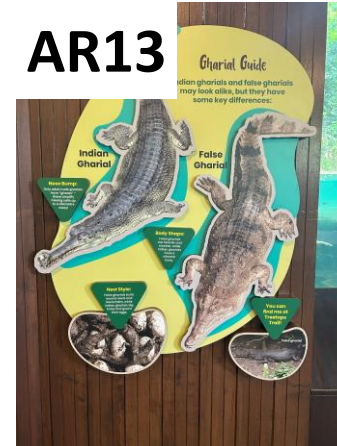
AR9



AR10



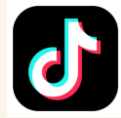
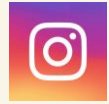
Interpretives at Armoured Reptiles Exhibit



Useful Links

- Mandai Official Site: <https://www.mandai.com/en.html>
- [Story map](#) on Mandai Sustainability Journey
- Mandai flagship app: <https://www.mandai.com/en/plan-your-visit/mandai-mobile-app.html>
- Mandai Education – Conservation Communication Framework [Link](#)

Mandai Socials



@MandaiWildlifeReserve

- *Stories on animal stories, animal care, local rescued animals, keepers, conservation and sustainability*

Animal Features - Mandai Monthly: [Link](#)

User-Generated Content - #AskMandaiAnything: [Link](#)

Conservation & Sustainability stories: [Link](#)

Animal Welfare Series: [Link](#)